

D709

Advanced Clinical in Secondary Education

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

Method © 2026 Erik Daniel Lindquist — Course Mastery Coach, armored drill. Items drafted with AI assistance under his direction.

How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer _____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
-----------------------------	---	------------------------	----------------------------------

Items

1.

A candidate planning a two-week unit on the causes of World War I, for a school that recently got new smartboards, starts by listing fun activities she found online. Her mentor, who coaches debate, suggests backward design. What should she do first?

- A. Write the daily activities.
- B. Plan a debate, since the mentor coaches debate.
- C. Write the unit test.
- D. Identify what students should understand and be able to do by the end.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A teacher has set clear goals for a unit. According to backward design, what comes next?

- A. Plan the learning activities.
- B. Revise the goals to fit favorite activities.
- C. Decide what assessment evidence will show students met the goals.
- D. Pick the textbook chapters.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A candidate designing a biology unit, whose placement school has a working greenhouse, drafts four questions. The unit runs for three weeks. Which is the best essential question?

- A. "Should humans use genetic engineering to change living things?"
- B. "What plants grow in our greenhouse?"
- C. "What is the function of DNA?"
- D. "Students will describe DNA structure with 80% accuracy."

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

Midway through a chemistry lesson in a classroom with a new periodic-table mural, a candidate asks a multiple-choice hinge question, and all 28 students hold up answer cards. Ten choose B, a choice that reveals confusion between mass and weight. Three students, all in the honors club, choose the correct answer quickly. What should she do?

- A. Move on, since the honors students answered quickly.
- B. Move on and address it on the unit test.
- C. Address the mass-weight misconception before moving on, possibly with a quick regroup for those ten.
- D. Reteach the whole lesson from the start.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A teacher sets a rule: move on if at least 80% of the class answers the hinge question correctly. In a class of 30, how many correct answers are needed?

- A. 6
- B. 24
- C. 80
- D. 38

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

In an English class where students write in new composition notebooks, a candidate gave argument-writing sentence frames in September. It is now December; most students write strong arguments, yet every student still must use the same frames. The class meets fourth period. What should change?

- A. Keep the frames for everyone to stay consistent.
- B. Add more frames for everyone.
- C. Remove all supports for every student at once.
- D. Fade the frames for students who no longer need them while keeping them for those who do.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A tenth grader who plays in the school orchestra scores 90 and 85 on two tests and gets a zero for a missing third test, which she later shows she has mastered. The school uses a 100-point scale. What is her average with the zero, and what does it suggest?

- A. About 58, a failing grade that does not reflect her demonstrated mastery.
- B. 175, her total points.
- C. About 58, which accurately shows what she knows.
- D. 87.5, which is accurate.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
-----------------------------	---	-----------------------	----------------------------------

8. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A teacher deducts 10 points from a student's essay score of 92 because the student talked during class. What is wrong with this practice?

- A. Nothing; behavior and learning are the same thing.
- B. The 82 no longer reports what the student learned; behavior should be reported separately.
- C. The deduction should be larger.
- D. The student should get a zero.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
-----------------------------	---	-----------------------	----------------------------------

9.

A candidate attends a ninth-grade math team's PLC meeting held in a conference room with a new coffee machine. The team leader has been at the school for 20 years. Which agenda item best fits a PLC's purpose?

- A. Plan the next coffee order.
- B. Discuss the parking lot schedule.
- C. Vent about difficult students.
- D. Review common assessment results and plan support for students who did not meet the standard.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
-----------------------------	---	-----------------------	----------------------------------

10.

A candidate in a school with a new mural celebrating local history plans a statistics lesson. She wants it to be culturally relevant. The class includes many students from the neighborhood. Which plan best fits all three pillars?

- A. Students analyze local data on bus service or park access, use their own neighborhood knowledge, and present evidence-based findings to a community group.
- B. Have students paint a mural.
- C. Lower the difficulty so every student feels comfortable.
- D. Add a slide about foods from students' cultures.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A lesson asks students to compare how two news outlets report the same event and why coverage might differ for their community. Which pillar is most directly addressed?

- A. Academic success only
- B. Critical consciousness
- C. None; comparing news is not culturally relevant.
- D. Cultural competence

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

A candidate reviews a video of her lesson for a performance assessment. The video was filmed on a new tablet and she thought the lesson felt smooth. The rubric criterion asks how she elicits student thinking. What is the best analysis approach?

- A. Focus on the video quality.
- B. Count only how long she talked.
- C. Note timestamps of the questions she asked and how students responded, then compare them to the rubric levels.
- D. Rate the lesson high because it felt smooth.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer D Concept 1

A candidate planning a two-week unit on the causes of World War I, ~~for a school that recently got new smartboards,~~ starts by listing fun activities she found online. Her mentor, ~~who coaches debate,~~ suggests backward design. What should she do first?

Target word: first stage **Decides:** Stage 1 is desired results.

A	Inverted operation	Activities come last in backward design.
B	Camouflage	The mentor's hobby does not set the first stage.
C	Adjacent category	Evidence is stage 2, after results are set.
D	Correct	Backward design begins with desired results.

2. Answer C Concept 1 • transfer

A teacher has set clear goals for a unit. According to backward design, what comes next?

Target word: stage after goals **Decides:** Stage 2: determine acceptable evidence.

A	Dropped element	Skips the evidence stage.
B	Inverted operation	Works backward from activities.
C	Correct	Evidence is the second stage.
D	Adjacent category	Resources are part of the learning plan, stage 3.

3. Answer A Concept 2

A candidate designing a biology unit, ~~whose placement school has a working greenhouse,~~ drafts four questions. ~~The unit runs for three weeks.~~ Which is the best essential question?

Target word: best essential question **Decides:** Open, arguable, worth revisiting.

A	Correct	Open-ended, arguable, and revisited across the unit.
B	Camouflage	A factual question drawn from the greenhouse detail.
C	Confusion set	A factual question with one answer.
D	Adjacent category	A measurable objective, not a question.

4. Answer C Concept 3

Midway through a chemistry lesson in a classroom ~~with a new periodic table mural,~~ a candidate asks a multiple-choice hinge question, and all 28 students hold up answer cards. Ten choose B, a choice that reveals confusion between mass and weight. Three students, ~~all in the honors club,~~ choose the correct answer quickly. What should she do?

Target word: decision from data **Decides:** 10 of 28 (about 36%) share a specific misconception.

A	Camouflage	A few quick correct answers do not represent the class.
B	Dropped element	Drops the responsive step the hinge is for.
C	Correct	The hinge data show a large, specific misconception.
D	Absolute language	The data point to one misconception, not a total reteach.

5. Answer B Concept 3 • transfer

A teacher sets a rule: move on if at least 80% of the class answers the hinge question correctly. In a class of 30, how many correct answers are needed?

Target word: solve for count **Decides:** 0.80×30 .

A	Inverted operation	That is the 20% allowed to miss.
B	Correct	$0.80 \times 30 = 24$.
C	Wrong stem number	Reads the percent as a count.
D	Confusion set	$30 \div 0.80 \approx 37.5$, more than the class.

6. Answer D Concept 4

In an English class ~~where students write in new composition notebooks~~, a candidate gave argument-writing sentence frames in September. It is now December; most students write strong arguments, yet every student still must use the same frames. ~~The class meets fourth period.~~ What should change?

Target word: what should change **Decides:** Scaffolds should fade as students gain independence.

A	Dropped element	Drops fading, limiting independence.
B	Inverted operation	Increases support when it should fade.
C	Absolute language	Some students may still need them.
D	Correct	Scaffolds are temporary and removed as skill grows.

7. Answer A Concept 5

A tenth grader ~~who plays in the school orchestra~~ scores 90 and 85 on two tests and gets a zero for a missing third test, which she later shows she has mastered. The school uses a 100-point scale. What is her average with the zero, and what does it suggest?

Target word: compute and interpret **Decides:** $(90 + 85 + 0) \div 3$.

A	Correct	$175 \div 3 \approx 58.3$; the zero distorts the report of learning.
B	Wrong stem number	The total, not the average.
C	Adjacent category	Right number, wrong interpretation.
D	Dropped element	Drops the zero; this is the average of two tests, not what the zero policy produces.

8. Answer B Concept 5 • transfer

A teacher deducts 10 points from a student's essay score of 92 because the student talked during class. What is wrong with this practice?

Target word: identify the problem **Decides:** Behavior mixed into an achievement grade.

A	Confusion set	They are different and should be reported separately.
B	Correct	Grades should reflect achievement of standards.
C	Inverted operation	Doubles down on mixing behavior into achievement.
D	Absolute language	Worsens the distortion.

9. Answer D Concept 6

A candidate attends a ninth-grade math team's PLC meeting ~~held in a conference room with a new coffee machine. The team leader has been at the school for 20 years.~~ Which agenda item best fits a PLC's purpose?

Target word: best agenda item **Decides:** PLCs examine student learning data and plan responses.

A	Camouflage	Pulls on the coffee-machine detail.
B	Adjacent category	A general staff issue, not learning.
C	Inverted operation	Complaints, not a focus on learning.
D	Correct	Answers "How will we know?" and "What if they don't?"

10. Answer A Concept 7

A candidate in a school ~~with a new mural celebrating local history~~ plans a statistics lesson. She wants it to be culturally relevant. The class includes many students from the neighborhood. Which plan best fits all three pillars?

Target word: best plan **Decides:** Rigor + students' knowledge as asset + questioning inequity.

A	Correct	Academic rigor, cultural competence, and critical consciousness together.
B	Camouflage	Echoes the mural detail; not a statistics lesson.
C	Inverted operation	Drops the academic-success pillar.
D	Dropped element	Surface-level; drops rigor and critical consciousness.

11. Answer B Concept 7 · transfer

A lesson asks students to compare how two news outlets report the same event and why coverage might differ for their community. Which pillar is most directly addressed?

Target word: name the pillar **Decides:** Questioning how society and power shape information.

A	Adjacent category	Rigor is present, but the core is critique of power.
B	Correct	Students question how institutions shape messages.
C	Absolute language	It is a common critical-consciousness task.
D	Confusion set	Cultural competence is valuing students' own cultures and others'.

12. Answer C Concept 8

A candidate reviews a video of her lesson for a performance assessment. The video ~~was filmed on a new tablet~~ and she thought the lesson felt smooth. The rubric criterion asks how she elicits student thinking. What is the best analysis approach?

Target word: analysis approach **Decides:** Collect specific evidence against the criterion.

A	Camouflage	The recording device is irrelevant.
B	Dropped element	Drops the students' responses, which the criterion asks about.
C	Correct	Evidence tied to the criterion.
D	Adjacent category	Impressions are not evidence.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	6	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	2	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	7	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	7	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	4	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	4	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	6	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Backward design	Plan in three stages: identify desired results, decide the acceptable evidence (assessments), then plan learning experiences.	Choosing favorite activities first and writing the test last.	The order in which a unit is planned.
2	Essential questions vs. objectives	Essential questions are open-ended, arguable, and worth revisiting across a unit; objectives are specific, measurable targets for a lesson.	Writing a factual question with one answer as an essential question.	“Is this a question with one right answer?”
3	Hinge questions and responsive reteaching	A hinge question mid-lesson, answered by every student, shows whether to move on, regroup, or reteach; wrong-answer choices should reveal specific misconceptions.	Moving on because a few strong students answered correctly.	A quick all-student check at a turning point.
4	Scaffolding and fading	Scaffolds give temporary support within the zone of proximal development and are gradually removed as students gain independence.	Keeping the same scaffold forever, or giving no support on a task beyond reach.	Support that is still in place after students show mastery.
5	Grading that reflects learning	Grades should report achievement of standards; mixing in behavior distorts them, and a zero on a 100-point scale pulls an average far more than any other score.	Averaging zeros for missing work or deducting points for behavior.	A grade that combines a zero or conduct points with test scores.
6	Professional learning communities	PLCs focus on four questions: What should students learn? How will we know? What if they don't? What if they already have?	Treating PLC time as a general staff meeting or complaint session.	A team meeting agenda.
7	Culturally relevant pedagogy	Culturally relevant teaching holds three pillars: academic success, cultural competence (students' cultures as assets), and critical consciousness (questioning inequities).	Reducing it to adding cultural foods or holidays to lessons.	A lesson that claims to be culturally responsive.
8	Video self-analysis against a rubric	Analyze recorded teaching by gathering specific evidence (timestamps, student talk, questions asked) and comparing it with rubric criteria, not by overall impressions.	Judging a lesson by how it felt or how smooth it looked.	A candidate reviewing a recorded lesson for a performance assessment.

Course scope (public description): Advanced Clinical provides aspiring educators with real-world classroom experience. This course emphasizes the importance of hands-on learning, offering candidates the unique

opportunity to observe and participate in classroom environments under the guidance of experienced mentors. The curriculum includes demonstrating reflective practice, classroom engagement techniques, instructional strategies, and effective communication skills with students and colleagues through a pedagogical performance assessment. Through this immersive experience, candidates not only observe the daily responsibilities of a teacher, but also start to develop their own teaching style and philosophy, laying a solid foundation for their future careers in education. This course is taken immediately prior to Student Teaching I as part of an engaging and intensive clinical experience.